

Evidence Before Adjectives

Turn broad claims into credible evidence a reader can question and trust.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Rewrite one résumé bullet so your action, context and result are visible without relying on adjectives.

HOW TO USE THE WORKING PAGE

Read this preview, then complete the next page before your next application, interview or offer conversation. The value is not in collecting advice; it is in making a decision visible enough to act on.

This is a sample briefing for educational reading. It is not a historic newsletter send and does not guarantee an interview, offer or outcome. Framework reference: [MIT Career Advising & Professional Development — STAR method](#).

Make the next step concrete.

Choose one claim you make about your leadership or expertise. What specific decision or outcome would make it believable?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

Name the operating context: what was changing, at risk or newly required?

State the action you personally took; avoid letting “we” hide your contribution.

Write the observable result and the question you could answer if a reviewer asked for proof.

YOUR ONE-SENTENCE COMMITMENT

The action I will take before my next career decision is:

Educational guidance only. Further reading: [MIT Career Advising & Professional Development — STAR method](#).

The ATS Translation Layer

Use a role's real language while keeping every claim honest and defensible.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Produce a role-to-evidence map that improves relevance without keyword stuffing.

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Make the next step concrete.

Select one target role. Which three phrases from its description best describe work you have genuinely done?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

Copy the phrase exactly as the employer uses it.

Add one specific project, decision or result that proves the match.

Remove any term you would struggle to explain aloud in an interview.

YOUR ONE-SENTENCE COMMITMENT

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Your Three-Story Interview Bank

Prepare a compact set of truthful stories that can adapt to more than one question.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Build three flexible examples before you need to answer under time pressure.

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Make the next step concrete.

Choose one change story, one problem-solving story and one learning story. What makes each useful beyond a single question?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

Write the situation in one sentence; keep context short enough to leave room for your action.

Name the decision, judgment or contribution that was distinctly yours.

State the result and the lesson you would carry into the target role.

YOUR ONE-SENTENCE COMMITMENT

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The Question Behind the Question

Decode difficult prompts into the capability an interviewer is trying to assess.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Choose a story based on the judgment required, not on the drama of the question.

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Make the next step concrete.

Take one difficult prompt: is it really asking about ownership, influence, resilience, judgment or self-awareness?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

Write the capability you think is being tested.

Choose a real example with enough stakes to demonstrate that capability.

End your answer with the result or reflection that makes the learning relevant now.

YOUR ONE-SENTENCE COMMITMENT

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Research, Reflect, Rehearse

Connect organisation research, your own evidence and natural spoken preparation.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Create a one-page preparation note that improves both your answers and your questions.

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Make the next step concrete.

Before your next interview, what should you know about the organisation—and what must you know about your own relevance?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

Record three signals about the organisation's current priorities or operating context.

Match each signal to one relevant experience, skill or question.

Practise the connection aloud in bullet points rather than memorising a script.

YOUR ONE-SENTENCE COMMITMENT

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The Executive Screen

Make the opening minutes of a recruiting or hiring-manager conversation easier to follow.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Craft a concise role-relevant introduction instead of a chronological career summary.

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[NYU Wasserman Center — Interviewing & Negotiation Process.](#)

Make the next step concrete.

What kind of operating situation do you tend to lead through, and why does it matter for this role now?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

Describe the business or operating problems you are most experienced at solving.

Choose one concise outcome that supports that positioning.

Ask a question that checks whether you have understood the mandate correctly.

YOUR ONE-SENTENCE COMMITMENT

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When They Ask About a Failure

Show ownership and learning without turning the story into blame or performance.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Prepare a responsible answer that describes what changed in your judgment or operating practice.

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Make the next step concrete.

Which setback can you discuss with honesty, appropriate context and a clear learning?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

State what happened without changing the facts or blaming another person.

Name the part you owned and the decision you would now approach differently.

Describe the practice, checkpoint or question you added afterward.

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Questions That Help You Evaluate the Role

Use interview questions to understand scope, success measures and decision rights.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Leave the conversation with evidence about the job—not merely the feeling that it went well.

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Make the next step concrete.

What do you need to understand before deciding the work, manager and operating environment fit your criteria?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

Write one question about success in the first six to twelve months.

Write one question about authority, influence and where decisions sit.

Write one question tailored to the interviewer's direct experience of the role.

YOUR ONE-SENTENCE COMMITMENT

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The Whole-Role Negotiation Map

Evaluate the offer as a whole role, not only as a headline salary number.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Compare compensation, benefits, scope and working conditions against your own decision criteria.

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Make the next step concrete.

Which parts of the role will matter most to your ability to do good work and make a sound move?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

List your non-negotiables before you receive an offer.

Separate fixed terms from questions that need clarification or may be open to discussion.

Request the written information you need to compare the complete package.

YOUR ONE-SENTENCE COMMITMENT

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Ask for Time Before You Answer

Treat offer review as a deliberate professional decision rather than a rushed reaction.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Create enough space to read the details, identify gaps and make an informed response.

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Make the next step concrete.

What information would you regret not asking for before you accept, decline or negotiate?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

Ask when the employer needs a considered response.

Read the written offer and note every term that is unclear or contingent.

Choose one trusted person who can challenge your assumptions without deciding for you.

YOUR ONE-SENTENCE COMMITMENT

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When Salary Cannot Move

Clarify the overall package and ask responsibly without assuming every term is negotiable.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Make one focused request or decide deliberately that the offer is right for your priorities.

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Make the next step concrete.

If base salary is fixed, what single term, piece of information or condition would most affect your decision?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

Ask which elements are governed by policy and which can be discussed.

Prioritise one or two requests rather than producing an unfocused list.

Decide whether the available package fits your stated criteria, not only your initial expectation.

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The Career Decision Memo

Make the trade-offs visible before momentum makes the decision for you.

WHAT THIS EDITION HELPS YOU DO

Write a short, candid decision note that names the evidence, risk and next question.

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Make the next step concrete.

In twelve months, what would need to be true for you to regard this move as a sound decision?

WORK THROUGH THESE THREE PROMPTS

State the opportunity in one sentence: mandate, reporting line and operating context.

Name the strongest evidence for fit and the clearest unresolved concern.

Write the next question you need answered before deciding.

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